



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Wisconsin



Federal Jury Finds Markita Barnes Guilty of Healthcare Fraud, Aggravated Identity Theft, Providing Unlawful Kickbacks, Obstruction, and Money Laundering

Friday, November 21, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Wisconsin

Brad D. Schimel, United States Attorney for the Eastern District of Wisconsin, announced that on November 21, 2025, Markita Barnes, the owner and operator of a now-defunct Prenatal Care Coordination Company called Here for You, was convicted of twenty federal charges, including Healthcare Fraud, False Statements related to Healthcare Matters, Anti-Kickback Statute violations, Aggravated Identity Theft, Obstruction of a Healthcare Fraud Investigation, and Money Laundering.

The evidence presented at trial established that Barnes and her employees exploited vulnerable pregnant women and young mothers by luring them into the company's prenatal care coordination program with kickbacks in the form of cash enrollment bonuses and free baby items such as car seats, pack 'n plays, diapers, and wipes. Once enrolled, Barnes's company unlawfully used the women's personal information to submit claims to Medicaid for services that were never provided, often backdating the claims to months before anyone at the company had met or enrolled the client. In reality, participants often received only occasional deliveries of diapers and wipes, and in some cases, nothing at all. The evidence also demonstrated that Barnes used her fraud proceeds to finance a lavish lifestyle, including luxury travel, designer clothing, and even a \$75,000 Mercedes.

The defendant is scheduled to be sentenced on March 17, 2026, by United States District Court Chief Judge Pamela Pepper. Markita Barnes faces a mandatory minimum 2-year sentence on the aggravated identity theft charges, and a maximum 20 years' imprisonment for each of the healthcare fraud charges.

The Federal Bureau of Investigation along with the Medicaid Fraud and Elder Abuse Control Unit investigated the case. Assistant United States Attorneys Julie F. Stewart and Kate M. Biebel prosecuted the case.

Updated November 21, 2025

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